

► CUTTING BY HAND

Quiltmakers generally cut with scissors if the pieces are small or intricate, or if they have unusual angles or shapes. Appliqué motifs are almost always best cut by hand. You should keep at least one pair of good-quality,

sharp dressmaker's scissors just for cutting cloth. Do not cut paper, template plastic, wadding, and the like with your fabric scissors. Most quiltmakers have several pairs of scissors in different sizes.

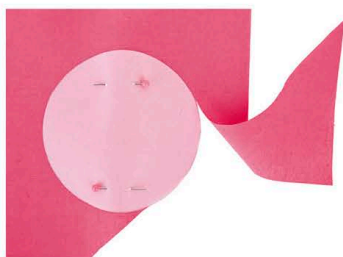
CUTTING WITHOUT A PATTERN



1 Mark the outline of the shape to be cut on the wrong side of the fabric and add the seam allowance, if you wish.

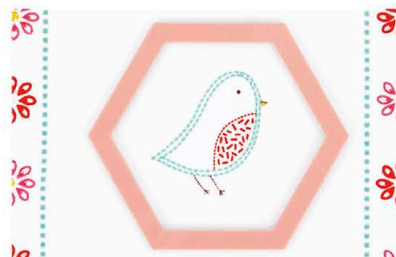
2 Cut out the shape along the marked cutting line – or cut a short distance away, if you have only marked the stitching line.

CUTTING WITH A PATTERN



Patterns made from paper are familiar to dressmakers and can provide an easy way for quiltmakers to cut the same shape several times over. Pin the pattern to the fabric and cut around it, adding the seam allowance if necessary.

FUSSY CUTTING



This is a method of isolating particular motifs in printed fabric and cutting them so they show as a feature in a block of patchwork or appliqué. It can seem wasteful of fabric, but the results are usually worth it. It is easier to delineate the area you want if you cut a window template to the desired size and shape.

► UNPICKING A SEAM

Everyone makes the occasional mistake and sometimes seams must be unpicked; moreover, some patterns depend on taking out seams during construction. It is vital that the unpicking process does not stretch the

edges of the fabric. Unpicking works best on seams that haven't been pressed. Never use scissors to unpick a seam.

METHOD 1



1 Working from the right side, insert the point of the seam ripper into the stitches to cut the thread.

2 Pull the layers of fabric apart gently as you work to the end of the seam.

METHOD 2



1 Working from the wrong side, hold the seam taut and insert the seam ripper into every third or fourth stitch to cut the thread. Work your way along the seam.



2 Hold the lower piece of fabric flat and pull gently on the top piece to separate the two. Do not use this method on bias seams.